

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in transactional document review, contract drafting and case file management at BCLP, Adobe and Citizens Advice. At Adobe reviewed and amended commercial agreements, assessed contractual risk and coordinated amendments across legal, sales and international business teams. At BCLP managed electronic case files and coordinated document production across complex, deadline-driven matters. Developing interest in asset finance and transactional work, sparked by exposure to ship and aircraft financing at an A&O Shearman finance workshop and followed up through a Coursera course on private equity structures. Seeking a paralegal role in a transactional shipping team where document drafting, file management and commercial awareness can be applied to high-value asset finance work.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and governance) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Supported acceptance of standard contractual terms: reviewed documentation, flagged provisions needing legal input and communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial; conducted legal research
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission

- Maintained structured electronic case files in iManage; monitored procedural deadlines
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage
- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Prepared client notes and managed correspondence across concurrent matters

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps; researches complex legal points
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis and contract review; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling

Case and evidence management: Transactional document review, case-file organisation, deadline tracking, procedural histories, hearing bundles, matter opening and closure